proposed a number of confidence-building measures to Pakistan. Within two weeks of the Gates visit, the 1990 crisis was over.[27]

What, if any, impact did India and Pakistan's de facto nuclear capabilities have on the outbreak and resolution of the 1990 crisis?

ŠUMIT GANGULY

Nuclear pessimists often stress how close India and Pakistan came to nuclear war in 1990.[28] Whether they came close to war, let alone nuclear war, remains an open question. The fact remains, however, that despite rising tensions on both sides, war did not ensue. Contrary to pessimists' accounts, war did not occur because both sides were cognizant of the dangers of nuclear escalation. During this crisis both sides resorted to substantial military deployments but in the end chose not to resort to war. In all three possible theaters of conflict, Kashmir, Punjab, and Rajasthan, both sides had large troop and armor deployments. In Kashmir, in response to the insurgency and in an effort to secure the porous line of control, India had placed as many as two hundred thousand military and paramilitary forces in Kashmir. Pakistan, in turn, had deployed at least a hundred thousand troops. At some locations the troops were a mere tenth of a mile apart.[29]

Significant Indian and Pakistani deployments were also evident in the Punjab in frontline bunkers. Specifically, across the border from Lahore, the capital of Pakistani Punjab, India had deployed two infantry divisions.[30] The most dramatic Indian force deployments, however, were in the desert state of Rajasthan. India had brought to bear a three-division strike force, which included an armored division. A Pakistani corps based in Multan opposed this Indian formation. It is also believed that during this crisis Pakistan moved its nuclear weapons from a storage facility in Baluchistan to an air force base that had F-16 fighter aircraft modified to deliver nuclear ordnance.[31]

Despite these force movements and deployments and the high level of tension, the two sides averted war. How? More to the point, why? Why did India, which was facing a serious crisis in Kashmir